

A Typical Day

Habits, routines & everyday life

LESSON	DETAILS
Level	A1 / A1+
Duration	60 minutes (55 min core + about 5 min flexibility for natural 1-to-1 interaction)
Class	1 teacher + 1 adult student · in person or online
Student profile	Adult doctor. Communicates successfully but makes frequent grammar slips.
Course	General English / Conversation — not a medical English lesson; medical vocabulary is personal context only.
Language reference	American English File 1, 3rd ed., Lessons 3A-3B and Grammar Bank 3A/3B (simple present + / - / ? , 3rd-person -s, verb phrases, jobs). Adapted, not reproduced.
Characters	Dr. Sarah — central fictional doctor (stages 3 and 6) · Dr. Ben — her colleague (stage 8, Round 1 only)
Materials	01 Student PPTX REV1.1 (17 slides, teacher notes in speaker notes) · 02 Student PDF REV1.1 (6 pages) · this plan (error log in Appendix C)

Main aim

By the end of the lesson, the student will be better able to use the simple present accurately to describe routines, habits and everyday activities, and to ask and answer questions about routines.

Subsidiary aims

- Review and expand useful daily-routine and work vocabulary; use verb phrases to describe their own routine.
- Improve accuracy with 3rd-person -s, do/does, don't/doesn't and the base verb after auxiliaries.
- Practise the pronunciation of 3rd-person -s (/s/ /z/ /iz/).
- Take part in short spontaneous exchanges about routines.

Target language

FORM	EXAMPLES
Affirmative	I work. · You work. · He works. · She works.
Negative	I don't work. · He doesn't work.
Questions	Do you work...? · Does he work...? · Where does she work? · What time does he start?
Short answers	Yes, I do. / No, I don't. · Yes, he does. / No, he doesn't.
High-priority errors	He work at a hospital → He works · He doesn't works → He doesn't work · Does he works? → Does he work ? · I am work → I work · He don't → He doesn't

Vocabulary

Routine: get up · have breakfast · go to work · start work · have lunch · take a break · finish work · go home · watch TV · go to bed.

Work / light medical (context only): work at a hospital · work at a clinic · see patients · examine a patient · check a patient · have appointments · check medical records · work on weekends. **Also in the Doctor's Day:** arrive at the clinic.

Assumptions

- The student already uses the simple present, but not accurately; the lesson is about accuracy in communication, not first presentation.
- The student knows most routine verbs; "examine", "medical records" and "appointments" may need eliciting in English.
- As a doctor, the student has a real routine to talk about — personalisation is genuine.
- Grammar terms are not needed; "base verb" is used only in this plan and on the pattern slide label.

Procedure

Stage · Time · Interaction · Procedure · Aim

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE	AIM
1. Lead-in "What's a typical day like for you?" SLIDES 1-2	4 min 0-4	T⇌S	Ask "What's a typical day like for you?" Follow up only as needed: "What time do you get up? What do you do in the morning? What time do you start work?" Don't correct. Start the error log.	Activate the topic; begin diagnosing spontaneous simple present.
2. Diagnostic speaking "Tell me about your day" SLIDES 3	5 min 4-9	S→T	"Tell me about a normal weekday — morning to evening." The student speaks along the day line. Support questions only when the student stops. Log errors.	Establish a baseline and identify priority errors.
3. Vocabulary discovery "A Doctor's Day" SLIDES 4-6	7 min 9-16	T⇌S	Introduce Dr. Sarah, the lesson's doctor. S4: times + icons only — Look. Guess. Say it: "What does she do at 7:00?" S5: reveal the phrases; the student retells her day; ask the 3 questions. S6: "Which of these do you do? When?" — true sentences, including negatives.	Review/expand routine and work vocabulary; connect it to the target language; personalise.
4. Language discovery "What's different?" SLIDES 7-8	7 min 16-23	T⇌S	S7: show the pairs with no highlighting. Ask one question at a time: What's different? Why "works"? Why doesn't "work" change? What comes after "does"? S8: the student states the pattern; confirm with the slide. Point to DOES + HE + WORK.	Guided discovery of the form: 3rd-person -s; doesn't / does + base verb.
5. Quick accuracy challenge "Right or Wrong?" SLIDES 9	5 min 23-28	T⇌S	"Right or wrong? Fix the wrong ones." The student corrects orally. Refer back to S8 rather than re-explaining.	Controlled accuracy practice.
6. Information gap "Who is it?" SLIDES 10-11	7 min 28-35	S⇌T	S10: "You know Dr. Sarah's day at the clinic. There are six more things you don't know. Ask me." Answer ONLY the information requested. If a question is wrong, don't answer: puzzled look / pause / elicit, and let the student self-correct. S11: question frames if needed; then "Tell me about Dr. Sarah."	Meaningful do/does question practice with a genuine information gap; 3rd-person retelling.
7. Pronunciation micro-focus "He works" SLIDES 12	3 min 35-38	T⇌S	NOTICE works / lives / watches → LISTEN (model ×2) → REPEAT → USE: "Tell me about a colleague." (If needed: "Where does he/she work? What does he/she do?")	Intelligibility of 3rd-person -s (/s/ /z/ /iz/).
8. Main communicative task "Doctor vs. Doctor" SLIDES 13-15	10 min 38-48	S⇌T	SUPPORTED → PERSONALISED → INDEPENDENT. R1 (S13): the student interviews you about Dr. Ben, Dr. Sarah's colleague. R2 (S14): you interview the student — choose 3-4 questions, not all six, and add natural follow-ups. R3 (S15): no prompts, 2-3 minutes of extended speaking. Monitor; don't interrupt. During R3, type 3-5 real errors into S16.	Transfer the target language to personalised, then independent communication.
9. Delayed correction "Can you fix it?" SLIDES 16	5 min 48-53	T⇌S	BEFORE SHOWING: replace the backup examples with 3-5 real errors from the student. Show one at a time: "Is it right?" "Can you fix it?" Guided self-correction; no re-explanation unless absolutely necessary; never more than one target error per sentence. Close with the pattern box.	Address priority errors without disrupting fluency.
10. Exit task "Tell me about your day" SLIDES 17	2 min 53-55	S→T	"So, what does a typical day look like for you?" A short final check: 4-5 sentences, no help (not a repeat of Round 3). Check with the exit checklist (Appendix D). Next-time preview only (How often...?) — do not teach it now.	Check progress against the main aim.

Total core time: 55 minutes. Use the remaining 5 minutes for natural follow-up conversation — don't stretch activities to fill it.

Stage notes

Teacher instructions · expected responses · language problems

STAGE	TEACHER SAYS	EXPECTED STUDENT RESPONSES	POTENTIAL LANGUAGE PROBLEMS
1 · Lead-in (4 min · slides 1-2)	"What's a typical day like for you?"	I wake up at six, I go to the hospital... I am work in a clinic. (diagnostic)	I am work / I working; missing -s in any he/she mention.
2 · Diagnostic speaking (5 min · slide 3)	"Tell me about a normal weekday — from the morning to the evening."	I get up at 6:30. I go to work by car. I see patients all morning...	Tense mixing (I went / I go); "I am..." + verb; he don't (if they mention colleagues).
3 · Vocabulary discovery (7 min · slides 4-6)	"This is Dr. Sarah. What does she do at 7:00? ... and at 8:30?" → "Which of these things do you do? When?"	She gets up. She arrives at the clinic. She sees patients... No, she doesn't. She works at a clinic. · She finishes at 6:00.	She see / she finish (no -s); "examine"; "medical registers" for medical records.
4 · Language discovery (7 min · slides 7-8)	"What's different?" / "Why do we say 'works' here?" / "What happens after 'does'?"	Works — because it's he. After does — no s. / Does has the s.	The student may over-apply -s (Does he works?) or say "because present". CCQ: "He — one person or more?" "Is 'works' OK after does?"
5 · Right or wrong? (5 min · slide 9)	"Right or wrong? Fix the wrong ones."	1 wrong — He works... · 2 wrong — I work... · 3 right · 4 wrong — Does he work... · 5 right	If the student accepts sentence 4 as correct, point back to DOES + HE + WORK and elicit the correction.
6 · Information gap (7 min · slides 10-11)	"You know Dr. Sarah's day at the clinic. Six more things — ask me." → "Now tell me about Dr. Sarah."	How many patients does she see a day? Does she work on Sundays? Does she work at night? Does she have appointments in the afternoon? What does she do after work? What time does she go to bed? She sees 15 patients a day. She doesn't work on Sundays...	How many patients she sees? / Does she works? / What time she go to bed? — withhold the answer until the question is well formed.
7 · Pronunciation (3 min · slide 12)	"Listen — are the endings the same?" → "Tell me about a colleague."	works /s/ · lives /z/ · watches /iz/ My colleague works at the hospital. She lives near me.	Adding an extra syllable to works ("work-es"); dropping the -s completely.
8 · Doctor vs. Doctor (10 min · slides 13-15)	R1 "Ask me about Dr. Ben — Dr. Sarah's colleague." · R2 "What time do you start work?" → "Every day?" → "What do you do first?" · R3 "Tell me about your typical working day."	Does he work at night? — Yes, he does. At 8. — Every day? — Yes, Monday to Friday. 2-3 minutes of connected speech in R3.	Mixing do/does across rounds (Do he...?); dropping -s in fluent R3 speech.
9 · Delayed correction (5 min · slide 16)	"Is it right? Can you fix it?" (one real error at a time)	He doesn't work on Sunday.	Correcting the wrong part — prompt with the pattern box, not an explanation.
10 · Exit task (2 min · slide 17)	"So, what does a typical day look like for you?"	4-5 spontaneous sentences	Measure: fewer slips from today's error log.

Problems & correction

Anticipated problems and solutions

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
The student communicates fluently, so errors “don’t matter” to them.	Use their own sentences in stage 9: real errors from their own speech make the grammar relevant.
Over-application of -s after does (Does he works?).	The DOES + HE + WORK strip (slide 8); ask “Where is the -s? — in does.”
“I am work / I am working” for routines.	Contrast once: “Now, in this lesson?” vs “every day?” Reformulate to I work; add it to the error log.
The student turns stage 4 into a request for rules.	Ask them to tell you the rule first; confirm in one sentence; move on.
The lesson drifts into medical English.	Keep medical terms as personal context; redirect to routine: “And after work?”
Stage 6 answers come too easily (the student guesses).	Answer only the information requested, and only well-formed questions; the six facts stay off-screen.
Round 2 becomes a mechanical questionnaire.	Choose 3–4 questions and add natural follow-ups (Every day? How often? Do you like working there?).
The student is tired of being corrected.	No correction in stages 1, 2 and 8 (fluency). Correction is concentrated in stages 5 and 9.
Time runs short.	Shorten stage 6 to four questions and Round 1 of stage 8. Never cut stage 9 or the exit task.

Error-correction strategy

Priority order: 1 simple present form · 2 third-person -s · 3 do / does · 4 don’t / doesn’t · 5 base verb after auxiliaries.

ERROR TYPE	EXAMPLE	WHAT TO DO	WHEN
Aim-critical (interferes with the lesson aim)	He work · Does she works? · He don’t	Log it. In controlled stages: elicit → guided self-correction (finger-point to the word, raise an eyebrow). In fluency stages: log only.	Stages 4–6 on the spot; everything else in stage 9
Minor / incidental	prepositions (at / in hospital), articles, tense slips outside the aim	Let it go unless it blocks meaning; at most one quick reformulation.	Rarely
Vocabulary gap	“examine”, “medical registers”	Supply the word naturally; add it to the board / chat.	Immediately — it helps the flow
Pronunciation	“work-es”, missing -s sound	Stage 7 model; later a quick echo only.	Stage 7, then light-touch

Techniques: elicitation (“He...?”) · reformulation (repeat correctly, move on) · guided self-correction (point to the pattern box) · delayed correction with the student’s real sentences (stage 9). Never correct more than one thing in a sentence.

Appendices

Teacher-only information

A • DR. SARAH — CENTRAL CHARACTER

Stage 3 (on screen): 7:00 gets up · 8:00 arrives at the clinic · 8:30 sees patients · 10:00 examines a patient · 12:00 has lunch · 1:00 sees patients · 4:00 checks medical records · 6:00 finishes work

STAGE 6 — TEACHER ONLY, DO NOT SHOW

Patients a day? She sees 15 patients a day.
Sundays? She doesn't work on Sundays.
At night? She doesn't work at night.
Appointments? Yes, she does. She has appointments in the afternoon.
After work? She watches TV after work.
Bed? She goes to bed at 11:00.

A • DR. BEN — DR. SARAH'S COLLEAGUE (STAGE 8, ROUND 1 ONLY — DO NOT SHOW)

Dr. Ben works at a hospital.
He starts at 8:00 in the evening.
He works at night.
He sees about 20 patients a night.
He works on weekends.
He doesn't work on Mondays.
He finishes at 6:00 in the morning.
Answer only what is asked, in the 3rd person.

B • RIGHT OR WRONG? KEY (STAGE 5)

- 1 He work in a clinic. → **wrong** — He works in a clinic.
- 2 I works from Monday to Friday. → **wrong** — I work from Monday to Friday.
- 3 She doesn't work at night. → **right**
- 4 Does he works on Saturdays? → **wrong** — Does he work on Saturdays?
- 5 Do you work at a hospital? → **right**

C • ERROR LOG (USE DURING STAGES 1, 2, 6 AND 8)

STAGE	WHAT THE STUDENT SAID	TYPE (-S / DO-DOES / DON'T-DOESN'T / BASE VERB / OTHER)	USE IN STAGE 9?

D • EXIT TASK CHECKLIST (STAGE 10)

☐ 4-5 sentences in the simple present ☐ routine vocabulary used ☐ 3rd-person -s correct where used ☐ questions / negatives correct where used ☐ fewer of today's logged slips than in stage 2

E • FOLLOW-UP LESSON

Frequency adverbs — always · usually · sometimes · never — and "How often do you work on weekends? / How often do you see patients?" Build it from this lesson's error log. Shown only as a small preview on slide 17 — do not teach it now.